

FinPilot: Project Summary

A simple, non-technical explanation of what has been built so far.

What is FinPilot?

FinPilot is a smart helper for your money. It looks at your income and spending and answers questions in plain language. It does **not** tell you what to invest in. It only explains your own money, using your own numbers.

- "Why did I spend more this month?"
- "Which subscriptions am I paying for?"
- "Am I on track to save for a new laptop?"

How does it get your money data?

- **Connect a bank (demo only):** You click "Connect Demo Bank" and approve a permission screen, like a real bank app. It then loads **pretend** data. It never touches a real bank account and never asks for passwords, PINs or OTPs.
- **Type it in yourself:** Add a transaction by hand, or upload a spreadsheet (CSV file) with many transactions.

Both ways end up in the same place, so the helper doesn't care where the data came from.

What FinPilot does with the data

- **Sorts transactions** into groups like Food, Shopping, Transport and Rent. If it gets one wrong, you can fix it and it remembers your fix.
- **Spots regular payments** like Netflix, rent and insurance, and shows them separately.
- **Notifies unusual spending**, for example "Shopping is 34% higher than usual". It states facts and never tells you what to do.
- **Makes a monthly summary** of income, spending, savings and where the money went.
- **Tracks budgets**, like "Food: 5,000 rupees a month", and shows how much you have used.
- **Tracks savings goals**, like "60,000 rupees laptop in 6 months", and shows whether your current saving pace can get you there.
- **Answers questions in chat** ("Ask FinPilot"). It looks up your real numbers before answering, so it does not guess.

What has been built and tested

- Sign up and sign in
- Demo bank connection with the permission screen
- Adding transactions by hand and uploading a CSV
- Sorting, regular-payment detection and unusual-spending detection
- Budgets and goals
- Pages: Dashboard, Ask FinPilot, Transactions, Budgets, Goals, Data Sources, Settings
- **Privacy:** one user can never see another user's data. This was tested and works.

All of this was tested by calling the app directly. It has not yet been clicked through in a browser.

What is not finished or not tested

- **The chat needs a Gemini key.** Without it the chat says "AI assistant unavailable". The real chat answers have not been tested yet, so please try it once.
- **Real bank connection (Setu)** is prepared but switched off. The demo uses pretend data. A real connection needs Setu's approval process.
- **Uploading a PDF bank statement** is not built. Typing and CSV upload work.

How to run it

- Open a terminal in the FinPilot folder and run: `npm install`
- Make sure the `.env` file has your Gemini key next to `GEMINI_API_KEY`
- Run: `npx prisma db push` (creates the small database file)
- Run: `npm run dev`, then open `http://localhost:3000`
- Register, click Connect Demo Bank, approve, then explore the Dashboard and Ask FinPilot

Where things are stored

Everything is saved in one small file on your computer (SQLite, `prisma/dev.db`). No separate database needs to be installed.